

Shoot Many Robots

A side-scrolling shoot 'em up game by Demiurge Studios is due out in 2011 as digital download.

Battlefield 3 on its way!

Showing off what the Frostbite 2 engine can produce in terms of graphics and gameplay, Battlefield 3 is coming to the Xbox 360, PlayStation 3, and PC.

SKOAR! Review

Bulletstorm: FPS reinvented?

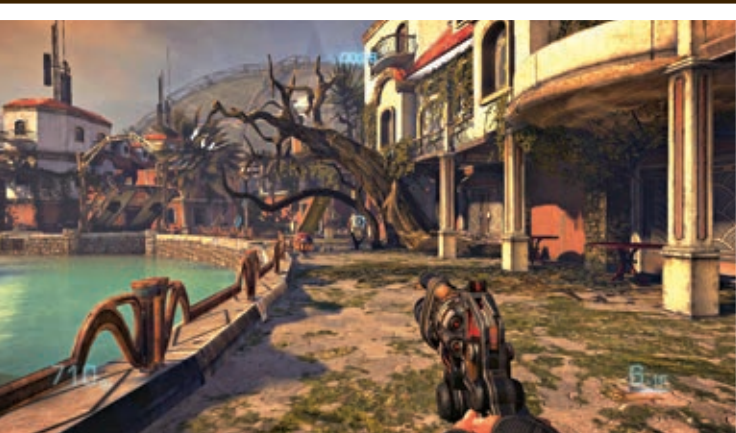
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A lot has been said about the irreverent first person shooter, Bulletstorm, and frankly, it does not deserve the massive attention it has been getting, from critiques of the scatological language and over-the-top violence, to praise for having reinvented the genre and satirized the plethora of military shooters out there.

or stylish points system.

Skillshot combinations are actually almost, kick a mine into the horde, shoot it, and then pick off heads one by one to get an Environmental+Afterburner+Headshot combo. Missed the head? Here's your chance to try for a throat shot (Gag Reflex), or to put your unlucky foe out of his misery after shooting him in the groin (Mercy). There are more than a hundred types of Skillshots in the game, some weapon



There are no awe-inspiring graphics showing off the latest Unreal Engine 3 improvements, it has an uninspired mockery of a storyline, the co-op and enemy AI is crude, and the single-player campaign is surprisingly short – clocking in at five to six hours or nineteen chapters in seven acts.

Bulletstorm doesn't set an archetype for future first person shooters to be inspired by, except by perhaps being the first FPS to effectively integrate a comprehensive and inventive 'Skillshot'

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specific, other chapter specific, and some, general or environmental.

All that hard work in an otherwise simple point A to point B shooter, gifts you Skillpoints. Your character, Grayson Hunt, picks up a Leash few minutes into the game, which allows you to pull enemies (one at a time) through the air towards you, bringing them closer for more moves like a Bullet-Kick. You can also upgrade the Leash to add the Thumper feature, which sends multiple enemies into the air where they stand, allowing you to take

your time to indulge in some Trap-Shooting, and more. It remains as the default left hand weapon throughout the game. Apart from the Leash, the kick and slide (both of which, like the Leash, also send opponents and objects flying, just away from you) Each weapon can also be upgraded with a limited number of charge shots, You can select a maximum of four weapons at a time, with two weapons of your choice apart from the Peacekeeper Carbine and the Leash. Switching to use different weapons on-the-fly during a Skillshot is usually well-rewarded.

Other than the Campaign, there are two other game modes in Bulletstorm – Echoes, and Anarchy. Echoes lets players try to get the best score in a single chapter/level run, where time, Skillshots, etc., are totaled to make the player's score for the level, and uploaded to global leaderboards. Anarchy mode is when a player and up to three of his/her friends or random

people online face 20 waves of enemies, taking them out with regular Skillshots, and Team Skillshots.

As for the coarse language, we weren't offended at all, and nor did we flinch. It felt very much a part of the game Verdict: Overall, the joyous barrage of violence that is the Bulletstorm experience is worth a purchase, and neglecting the cliché and abrupt storyline, the addictive Echoes and Anarchy modes are the true selling points of the game, pitting your Skillshot creativity and precision against the hordes of frenzied gamers online. **d**

Pros

- Interesting gameplay mechanics
- Addictive leaderboard (Echoes) and multiplayer (Anarchy) modes
- Visually appealing environments

Cons

- No mind-blowing graphics
- Short single player campaign
- Some graphical glitches

Details

Genre: First Person Shooter, Arcade
Studio: People Can Fly, Epic Games
Publisher: Electronic Arts, Milestone Interactive
Platforms: PC (MS Windows), PlayStation 3, Xbox 360